

Why so serious with gender benders?

On Wednesday, **the top court** in the land of Rudyard Kipling **ruled** that 'woman is woman, and man is man, and never the **twain** shall meet'. According to Britain's Equality Act 2010 - by which people are protected against discrimination based on age, disability, gender reassignment, marriage and civil partnership, pregnancy and **maternity**, race, religion/belief, and **sexual orientation** - women (and men) are to be defined by their biological gender status, the gender in which they were born. While Britain's Supreme Court **assured** this would not **dilute** protection given to transgender women or men - people whose gender identity **differs** from the sex with which they were born - as they would be protected by the equality law, the ruling does **highlight** Western societies' **strange obsession** to classify everything **under the sun** by **pegging** them **down** in categories, and to think in terms of **binaries** (e.g., Whites vs 'people of colour').

Defining features, much like values, change over time. A 'blind spot' applied to women, Jews and, later, Muslims in the Republican France of 'liberte, egalite, fraternite'. **The Equal Protection Clause**, **embedded in** the 14th Amendment of the US Constitution, **took effect** in 1868. While it **mandated** every person equal legal protection, initially, and for a significant period afterward, it didn't guarantee equality for women or Blacks. Until the Civil Rights Act finally **outlawed** discrimination based on race, colour, religion, sex or national origin in 1964, a **mere** five years before the first (hu)man landed on the moon. When US Congress **ratified** 'all' women the right to vote in 1920, African-American women were kept out of the 'all women' **fray** for **decades**.



While **things** like what **constitutes** 'womanly' behaviour - or, for that matter, 'manly behaviour' - **have** thankfully expanded and **changed** over time, definitional **dogma** even in liberal societies **lingers** in the name of protecting against **dilution** of women's rights. This is **artificial legalese**. In a world of **fluid ethnicities**, nationalities, etc, **gender fluidity** should be a given. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

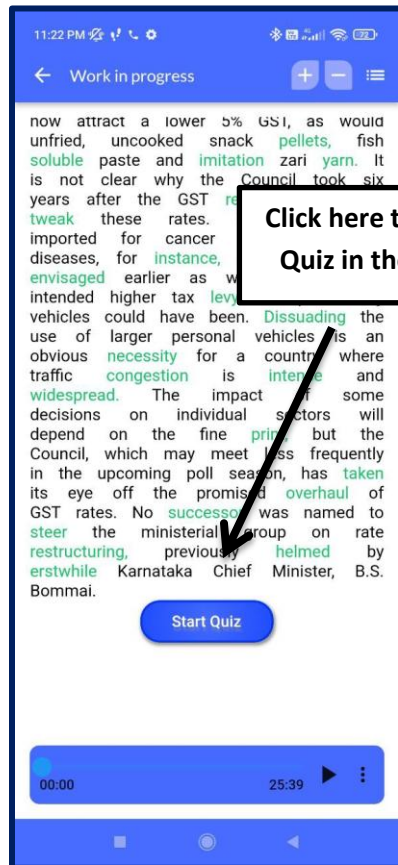
1. **Gender bender** (noun) – a person who dresses or behaves like a member of the opposite sex लिंग की पारंपरिक धारणाओं को चुनौती देने वाला व्यक्ति
2. **Rule** (verb) – decide, decree, pronounce, adjudicate, declare निर्णय देना
3. **Twain** (noun) – two, pair, duo, couple, dyad दो चीजें
4. **Maternity** (noun) – motherhood, pregnancy, childbirth, parenthood, maternal state – मातृत्व
5. **Sexual orientation** (noun) – a person's identity in relation to the gender or genders to which they are sexually attracted; the fact of being heterosexual, homosexual, etc. यौन झुकाव
6. **Assure** (verb) – guarantee, affirm, ensure, promise, confirm आश्वासन देना
7. **Dilute** (verb) – weaken, reduce, diminish, lessen, thin कमजोर करना
8. **Differ** (verb) – vary, contrast, diverge, disagree, deviate भिन्न होना
9. **Highlight** (verb) – emphasize, underscore, stress, spotlight, point out जोर देना
10. **Strange** (adjective) – unusual, odd, peculiar, bizarre, unfamiliar अजीब
11. **Obsession** (noun) – fixation, mania, preoccupation, compulsion, craze जुनून
12. **Under the sun** (phrase) – in existence, anywhere, everywhere, in the world, in reality दुनिया में / जहां कहीं भी
13. **Peg down** (phrasal verb) – categorize, fix, label, pin down, define वर्गीकृत करना
14. **Binary** (noun) – something having two parts. द्वैध व्यवस्था
15. **Embed** (in) (verb) – insert, incorporate, implant, fix, enshrine समाहित करना
16. **Take effect** (phrase) – become operative, come into force, start, commence, apply लागू होना
17. **Mandate** (verb) – authorize, decree, order, prescribe, require आदेश देना / अनिवार्य करना
18. **Outlaw** (verb) – ban, prohibit, criminalize, forbid, disallow प्रतिबंधित करना
19. **Mere** (adjective) – only, just, simple, slight, insignificant मात्र
20. **Ratify** (verb) – approve, confirm, endorse, validate, authorize अनुमोदन करना
21. **Fray** (noun) – conflict, struggle, dispute, tussle, contest संघर्ष / विवाद
22. **Decade** (noun) – Period of ten years दशक

23. **Constitute** (verb) – form, make up, compose, establish, create बनाना
24. **Dogma** (noun) – belief, doctrine, principle, ideology, conviction मत / कट्टर विचार
25. **Linger** (verb) – persist, remain, stay, continue, endure टिके रहना
26. **Dilution** (noun) – weakening, reduction, diminishment, attenuation, degradation कमजोर पड़ना / पतलापन
27. **Artificial** (adjective) – unnatural, man-made, fake, contrived, synthetic कृत्रिम
28. **Legalese** (noun) – legal jargon, technical language, law-speak, formal wording, legal terminology कानूनी भाषा
29. **Fluid ethnicity** (noun) – the idea that an individual's sense of belonging to a particular ethnic group can change over time and across different contexts परिवर्तनशील जातीयता
30. **Gender fluidity** (noun) – It refers to a non-fixed gender identity and/or expression that changes over time लिंग परिवर्तनशीलता

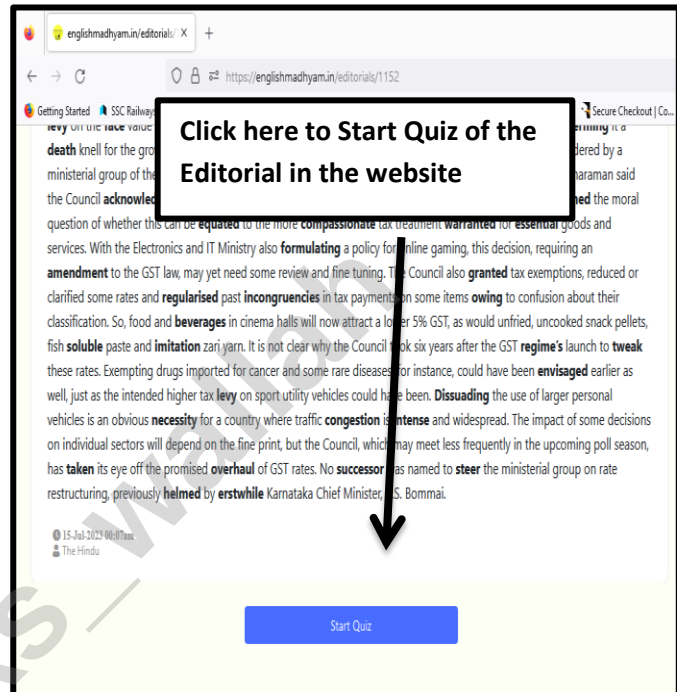
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Supreme Court Ruling** – Britain's Supreme Court ruled that legal definitions of "woman" and "man" should align with biological sex at birth.
2. **Equality Act 2010** – The ruling is based on the Equality Act 2010, which protects against discrimination, including gender reassignment.
3. **Trans Rights Maintained** – The Court emphasized that transgender individuals still receive protection under equality laws.
4. **Binary Thinking Critiqued** – The editorial criticizes Western societies' tendency to classify people strictly into binary categories.
5. **Obsession with Labels** – There's a cultural compulsion to rigidly define identities such as race and gender, which may ignore social realities.
6. **Historical Blind Spots** – Even progressive societies like Republican France had discriminatory blind spots against women, Jews, and Muslims.
7. **US Equal Protection Clause** – The US Constitution's Equal Protection Clause initially failed to guarantee rights to women and Black Americans.
8. **Slow Progress** – Legal equality came slowly; for instance, the US Civil Rights Act only passed in 1964, nearly a century after the 14th Amendment.
9. **Women's Voting Rights** – Although US women gained the right to vote in 1920, African-American women were largely excluded for decades.
10. **Changing Gender Norms** – Societal ideas of "manly" and "womanly" behavior have broadened over time, reflecting social evolution.
11. **Persistence of Legal Dogma** – Despite social change, legal systems often cling to rigid definitions under the guise of protecting rights.
12. **Artificial Boundaries** – The editorial labels such strict legal definitions as artificial and outdated.
13. **World of Fluid Identities** – Ethnic, national, and gender identities are increasingly fluid in today's interconnected world.
14. **Call for Inclusivity** – There's an implicit call for laws to reflect the evolving, nuanced understanding of identity.
15. **Progress vs. Protection** – The piece suggests that protecting rights should not come at the cost of excluding or invalidating fluid identities.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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